

Chapter 75-2

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On the way home from the company, Xu Qingzhu forced herself to stay alert while driving, not daring to relax for a single moment.

Only when the car had pulled into the villa's courtyard did she turn off the engine. She slumped over the steering wheel, feeling her entire back soaked with sweat, her legs weak and limp, unable to exert any strength.

Su Zhe had tried his best to suppress his emotions while recounting those events from back then, but as he spoke, his eyes gradually reddened.

He didn't even curse her grandparents, truly doing as Xu Qingzhu had requested—recounting the events from back then as objectively as possible.

Xu Qingzhu followed his words back to twenty-three years ago.

Back to the days that had been most painful for Su Yao.

If she hadn't met Su Yao before, this story might not have carried much weight for Xu Qingzhu.

At most, her sympathy would have overflowed, and she would have commented that it was truly tragic.

But she had seen Su Yao twice.

Once was watching her silhouette from afar, and once was going up to confront her.

Though it was only her performing a one-woman show.

After all, Su Yao had lost her memory and didn't remember anything.

After hearing everything Su Zhe said, she suddenly felt regret—if only she hadn't appeared in front of Su Yao.

That way, she could have pretended she didn't know anything and continued living on her original track.

But now...

Xu Qingzhu had completely fallen into a dilemma.

Meanwhile, Liang Shi, who had been sent back to the villa by a designated driver, was currently sitting crookedly on the sofa, staring intently at her phone.

Ten minutes ago, she had sent a message to Xu Qingzhu that still hadn't received a reply.

She had asked Xu Qingzhu: 【Do you think I'm too indecisive?】

No reply!

But the previous message had been replied to instantly!

Liang Shi sat there, her whole brain fuzzy and dizzy, her head aching.

She pressed her temples, trying to relieve the pain, when she heard that familiar mechanical sound ring out in her mind.

【Ding dong! Congratulations to the Host for completing the hidden mission: Find Xu Qingzhu's biological parents!】

Liang Shi: "?"

What was it saying?

She was completely bewildered.

The System continued to announce: 【Reward received: One million yuan. Additionally, because the Host completed the mission within fifteen days, bonus reward of two hundred thousand yuan, totaling one million two hundred thousand yuan. This reward will be deposited into your account within ten minutes. Please check and confirm!】

【PS: Little Tong finds this incredible, so I checked the Host's luck attribute and discovered it's actually 3S! Is this the joy of being a lucky player?】

【Another PS: This mission also has an additional reward. If you can help Xu Qingzhu reunite with her parents, there will be an extra reward of five hundred thousand yuan. Of course, Xu Qingzhu doesn't have a father now.】

【Yet another PS: Little Tong also really wants to experience the joy of winning while lying down. Not having to do anything yourself and having someone else help complete the mission—it's just too wonderful!】

【One more PS: Congratulations to the Host for obtaining a new title: Lucky Salted Fish!】 ^1^

Liang Shi: "....."

She was dazed for a long time. It wasn't until the words "Lucky Salted Fish" appeared that Liang Shi slowly came back to her senses: "Does this title have any use?"

System: 【It's purely a title that Little Tong bestowed upon you. It has no practical use, but it can very well summarize your state during this mission! Are you satisfied?】

A chatty system was really quite unlikeable.

Especially when Liang Shi had a headache.

Liang Shi was speechless, thinking to herself—when had her life ever been associated with the words "lucky" and "salted fish"?

Both parents dead, she had always depended on her grandparents for survival. After her grandparents passed away, she couldn't afford proper schooling due to financial difficulties. While others were happily living in the cradle of family, she had already started working odd jobs everywhere to support herself.

The little luck she had was used up in meeting her grandparents and entering the entertainment industry. But unexpectedly, not long after entering the entertainment industry, before she could even struggle for many years, she was blacklisted across the entire internet because of filming a yuri drama, with her rivals paying for smear articles.

Her brief life could be quickly summarized.

How could it possibly be associated with the word "lucky"?

This system was ridiculous!

Moreover, she had always been conscientious and hardworking, so she couldn't possibly be associated with "salted fish" either.

After quickly recalling all this, she retorted to the System: "Not satisfied."

System: 【There's nothing that can be done about it. After all, you earned over a million just lying down. Little Tong is jealous and envious, ying ying ying!² Right now, Little Tong is a lemon spirit.】³

System: 【The whole world is helping you complete your missions—if this isn't called lucky, then what is?! You have a misunderstanding about your own luck attribute. It really, really is 3S level.】

"Is your understanding of luck over there different from ours?" Liang Shi asked. "Is 3S the lowest?"

System: 【.....】

The strange mechanical voice suddenly became shrill: 【It's F! F! The order is C-B-A-S-2S-3S-5S.】

Liang Shi: ".....?"

"What about your 4S?"

【4S is for car dealership service centers.】⁴

Liang Shi: "?"

Hello?⁵

Do you think you're funny?

But after that, the System just reminded her to keep working hard and complete missions properly—same as before, just repeating itself over and over.

Liang Shi forcefully exited, not wanting to listen to its useless rambling.

After she exited, she noticed that her account had an additional 1.2 million, and it slowly dawned on her—

What did the System just say?

It said she completed a hidden mission?

So... Xu Qingzhu knew about her own background now?

Knew everything?

Questions kept popping up in her mind. She almost instinctively took out her phone to call Xu Qingzhu, but when her finger slid to that number, she paused.

She got up and turned on all the lights in the house, making it very bright. Then she casually grabbed a coat from the entryway and went outside to wait for Xu Qingzhu.

But after she went outside, she discovered that Xu Qingzhu's car was already parked out there.

Footnotes:

¹ **Salted Fish (咸鱼)**: Chinese internet slang for someone who has no ambitions or motivation, just wants to lie around and do nothing—like a salted fish that's already dead and preserved. It's often used self-deprecatingly or humorously.

² **Ying ying ying (呜呜呜)**: A cutesy onomatopoeia representing whimpering or crying sounds, often used playfully online to express being pitifully sad or jealous.

³ **Lemon spirit (柠檬精)**: Chinese internet slang for someone who is extremely jealous or envious, derived from the sour taste of lemons representing the bitter feeling of jealousy.

⁴ **4S**: In China, "4S店" refers to automobile dealerships that provide four services: Sale, Spare parts, Service, and Survey. The System is making a pun, avoiding "4S" in its ranking system because it's commonly associated with car dealerships.

⁵ **Hello? (歪?)**: "歪" (wāi) is a casual/colloquial way of answering the phone in Chinese, similar to "Hello?" The literal meaning is "crooked/slanted," but it's used as phone greeting slang. Here, Liang Shi is using it rhetorically to express disbelief, like saying "Excuse me?" or "What?"